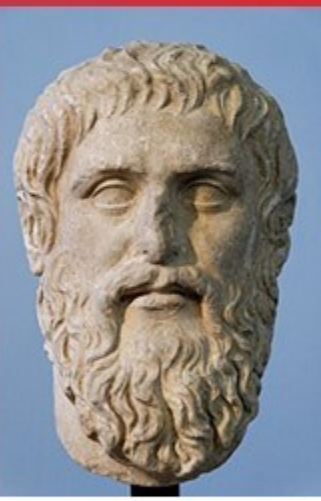
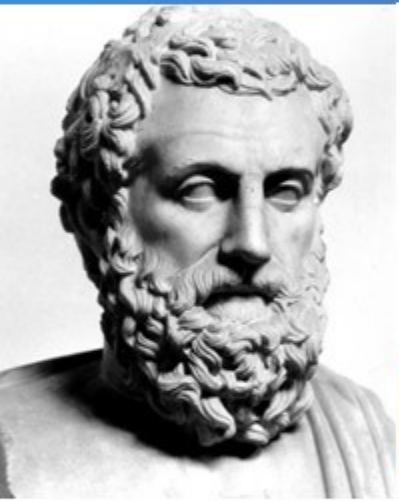


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



ATTITUDE

MODULE – 22

**PERSUASION, SOCIAL
INFLUENCE**

Read an article about successful women

A person having somewhat positive attitude towards women empowerment may feel more positive.

Another person may think women are becoming too powerful and may begin to develop negative attitude.

Characteristics of the existing attitude such as **valence** (positivity or negativity, **extremeness**, **simplicity** or **complexity** and **significance** of the attitude.

Attitude may change in the same direction (**congruent**) or in opposite direction (**incongruent**).

Attitude may change in the direction of the message of the persuasion. **Fear** may work to **convince** people **but** too much fear may have **negative effect**.

Source credibility and attractiveness: Persuasion is more effective if the message comes from a **highly credible source**. The credibility of a source depends on the views of the audience.

Cook food in a
pressure cooker

Saves fuel and is economical
(rational appeal)

Preserves nutrition and is good
for your family (emotional appeal)



A campaign for ORS for young children is more effective if community social workers and doctors communicate directly to the people rather than promoting the same through television or radio.

Message characteristics: Persuasion is more likely when the amount of information given is just enough, neither too much nor too little.

Whether the message contains rational or emotional appeal, and the motives activated by the message also make a difference

The mode of spreading the message: The direct transmission (face-to-face), than indirect transmission, is more effective.

Target characteristics such as persuasibility, strong prejudices, self-esteem and intelligence also affect persuasion.

GROUPS

In everyday life, we interact with several people, both personally and professionally.



CROWD



AUDIENCE

Crowd is a group **without** any **structure**. **Teams** are **special groups** whose members have complementary skills and are committed to a common goal.

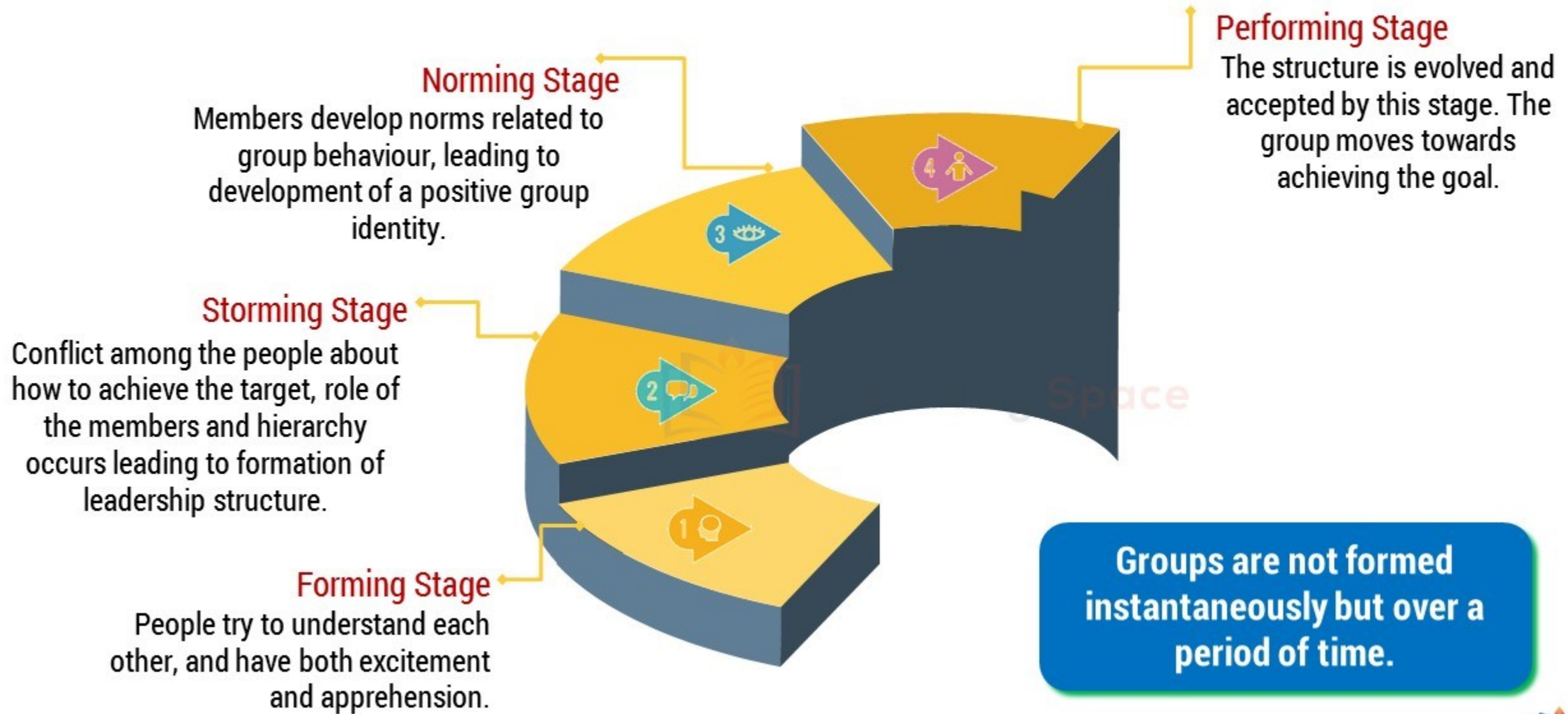
Audience is a collection of people who assemble for a special purpose.

We **become** part of **groups** that not only provide the needed **support** and **comfort** but also facilitate our **growth** and **development** as individuals.

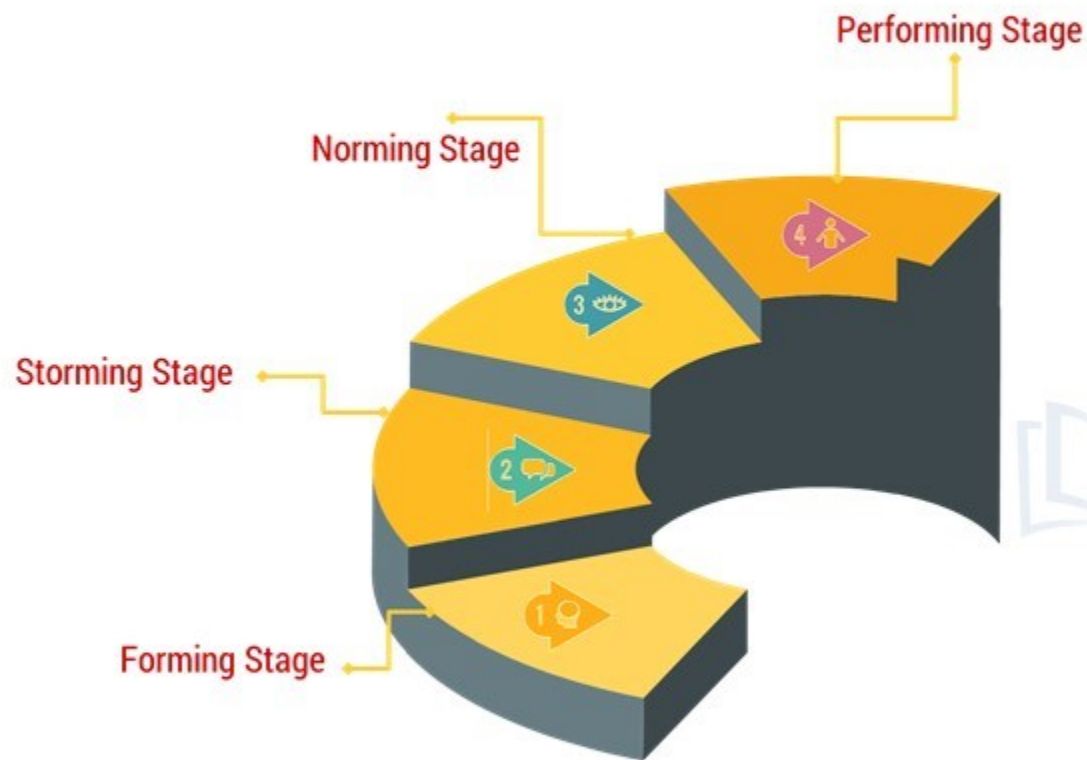
A group is an organised system of multiple individuals who

- are **interacting** and **interdependent**
- have **common motives**
- have a set of **role relationship** among its members
- have **norms** that regulate the behaviour of its members
- try to **satisfy a need** through their joint association
- **influence** each other
- **interact** with each other through a set of roles and norms

GROUP FORMATION



GROUP FORMATION



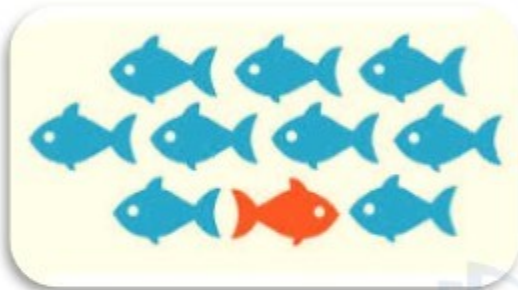
All groups do not always proceed from one stage to the other in a systematic manner.

Sometimes several stages go on simultaneously, while in other instances groups may go back and forth through different stages or they may skip some of the stages.

People join groups for several reasons such as security, status, self-esteem, satisfying one's psychological needs, goal achievement, and knowledge/information.

Basic to group formation is contact and interaction which is facilitated by: proximity, similarity, and common motives and goals.

*There are four important elements of group structure:
roles, norms, status, cohesiveness.*



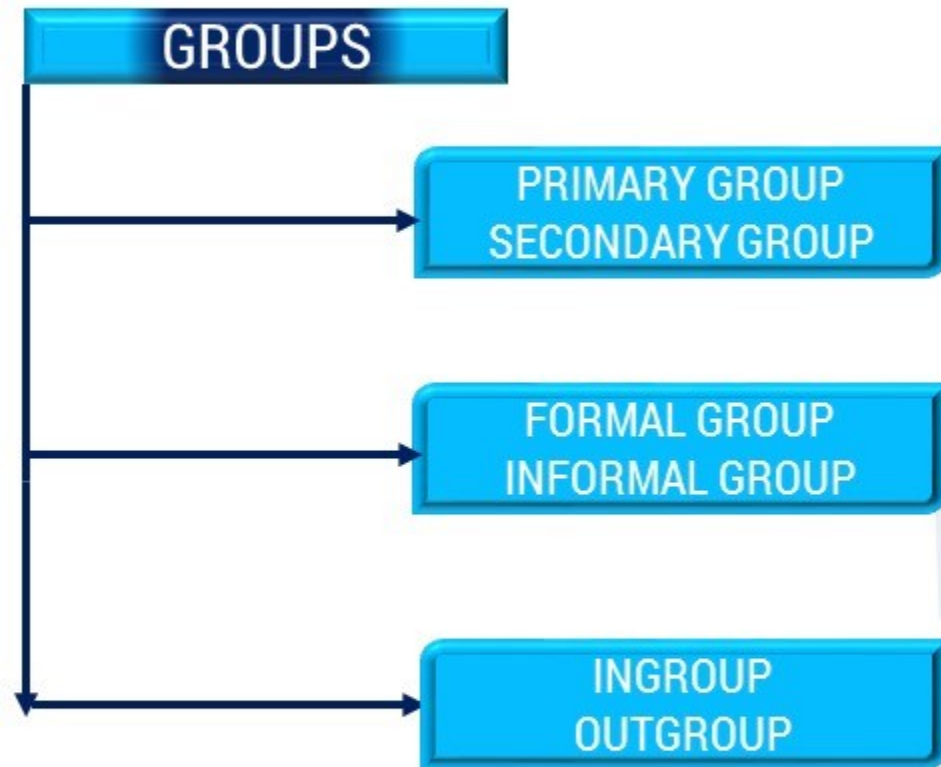
Roles: socially defined expectations that individuals are expected to perform in a given social context.

Norms: expected standards of behaviour and beliefs established, agreed upon and enforced by group members.

Status: the relative social position or status, which can be either ascribed or achieved, given to group members by others.

Cohesiveness: togetherness, bonding or mutual attraction among the group members.

TYPES OF GROUPS



Ingroup is one's own group (we) and **outgroup** refers to another group (they).

Primary groups are preexisting formations such as family, caste and religion which are usually given to the individual. These are central to individual's functioning and have a major role in developing values and ideals during the early stages of development.

Secondary groups are those which the individual joins by choice. In secondary groups, relationships among the members are more impersonal, indirect and infrequent.

In **formal groups**, the roles of the members are explicitly stated and set of norms are well established, whereas it is not the case in **informal groups**.

The influence of groups on the performance of an individual depends on the situation.



Robert Zajonc

- (i) **Social facilitation**: an individual performing alone in front of others.
- (ii) **Social loafing**: performing along with others as part of a group.

SOCIAL FACILITATION

- **Task performance** can be facilitated and improved or inhibited and worsened by the presence of others.
- Performance improves because of **arousal** which makes the person perform in an intense manner – Zajonc.
- **Arousal is because** the person feels he or she is being evaluated (evaluation apprehension) – Cottrell.
- The **nature of the task** to be performed also plays a role: If it is a complex task, the performance decreases.

SOCIAL LOAFING

Individuals work less hard in a group than they do when performing alone. This phenomenon is called **social loafing**.

Social loafing: reduction in individual effort working on a task in which outputs are pooled with those of other group members.

It occurs because:

- Group members **feel less responsible**
- Less motivation because **individual efforts are not evaluated**
- **Performance is not compared** with other group
- Missing of **coordination**
- **Belonging** to the same group is **not important** for some individuals



Groups and individuals may influence us to change our attitudes or behaviours in a particular direction.



Herbert Kelman

Social influence refers to the processes whereby thoughts, feelings and behaviour of individuals are influenced by actual, imagined or implied presence of others. (ALLPORT, 1968)

In **some situations**, social influence is **very strong resulting** in change of our attitudes. In **other situations**, we are able to **defy the influence** of others and may even influence them to change their attitudes.

There are three important **group influence processes**: conformity, compliance and obedience.

There are **three forms of social influence**: compliance, identification and internalization



Your colony residents are signing a petition requesting to ban the use of loud speakers during religious festivals. You personally believe that this rule is to be enforced. But, you also know that if you don't sign, you may lose many friends and disrupt the unity.



Compliance: External conditions force the individual to accept the influence of the significant other. Happens when people agree with others but do not disclose their own opinions.

You are signing the petition because you are requested to do so by significant other(s).

SOCIAL INFLUENCE



You **may agree** not because of a group norm, or even because you believe in the message, but **because** you see no harm in doing so.

A member of an environment group requests you to put a sticker 'Say No to Plastic Bags' on your car.

Identification: Influence process **based on agreement-seeking or identity-seeking.** Happens when people get influenced by someone who is liked or respected.

Internalisation: It is based on **information seeking**, and happens when a belief or behaviour is completely internalised and agreed to both publicly and privately.

CONFORMITY

*There are three important group influence processes:
conformity, compliance and obedience.*



Muzafer Sherif
Autokinetic Effect



Moses Asch
Asch technique

The tendency to **follow a norm** is **natural**, even when there is no punishment, except displeasure or disapproval of the group, for not following the norms.

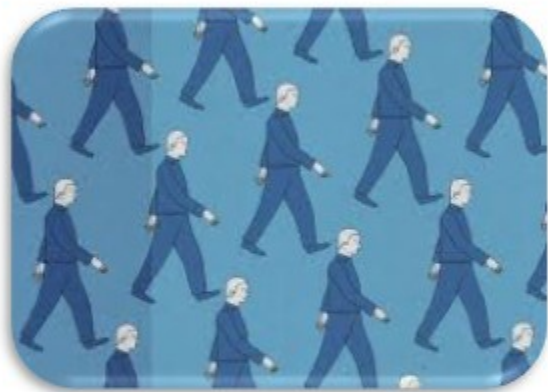
People **feel uncomfortable** if they are **considered different** from others for not following the norms. Behaving differently may **attract disapproval** or **dislike** by others, which is a form of **social punishment**.

The **norms** are **seen as** reflecting the **views of the majority**, and most people think that majority is more likely to be right than wrong.

In KBC, contestants choose the same answer that majority feel is correct.

CONFORMITY

The *degree of conformity* is determined by many factors which are situation specific.



Size of the group: Conformity is greater when the size of the group is smaller because it is easier for a deviant member to be identified in smaller groups.

Minority size: When the deviant minority size increases, the likelihood of conformity decreases.

Personality: Some individuals have a conforming personality, and they tend to change their behaviour according to what others say or do in most situations.

Public or private expression: Conformity is less in private situations than in public situations.

COMPLIANCE

Several techniques have been found to work when someone wants other person to comply.



Sometimes we end buying unwanted products from a salesperson who comes to our door.

Compliance usually **occurs because** it is the **easy way out** of the situation, is more **polite**, or the **other party is to be pleased**.

The foot-in-the-door technique: The person **begins with a small request** that the other person is unlikely to refuse. When that request is carried out, another bigger request is made.

The deadline technique: A **last date** for the product or offer availability **is made** with an aim of making people hurry and make the purchase.

The door-in-the-face technique: You begin with a large request and when it is refused, later a smaller and desired request is made, which will be accepted.

OBEDIENCE

People in authority have effective means to enforce their orders.



Obedience is compliance shown to an instruction or order from a person of authority such as leaders or teachers.

Milgram's experiment

Most people obey because failure to do so may attract punishment, or because sometimes we believe that persons in authority must be obeyed.

People obey even if they know that their behaviour harms others because

- they feel that they are not responsible for their actions
- people find it difficult to resist authority
- events are moving at such a fast pace that people have no time to think (such as when a riot takes place)

FACTORS AFFECTING SOCIAL INFLUENCE

Several factors play a role in how effective the social influence is.



Charisma: People who have beauty, wealth or higher social status usually yield greater influence of people because their attributes attract confidence in a person, boosting self-esteem.

Peer Pressure: People sometimes behave contrary to their normal behaviour just to maintain positive relationship with other group members such as friends.

Social Trends: People normally get swayed by the latest social trends, especially if they are creative, as they have great social influence.

Credibility: The credibility of the source plays a great role in the influence that source can exert.

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